

WHISTLEBLOWING POLICY

Scope

The Firm's whistleblowing policy is intended to encourage its employees and others to report suspected or actual occurrence(s) of illegal, unethical or inappropriate events (behaviours or practices) without retribution. It aims to encourage and enable employees and others to raise serious concerns within the Firm prior to seeking resolution outside the Firm.

VARA's expectation on whistleblowing focuses on reporting regulatory concerns. This is understood as a concern held by any person that the Firm, an officer or employee of the Firm, an Affiliate¹ of the Firm or an officer or employee of the Affiliate has or may have contravened a provision of legislation administered by VARA or engaged in money laundering, fraud or any other financial crime. Individuals may also wish to report concerns on other matters like HR issues, employment disputes, etc. which are relevant to the Firm's day-to-day activities and reflect the culture of the Firm. These may also be areas of interest to VARA.

Policy

- Any whistleblower can report an event with his/her identity or anonymously if they wish to.
- No director, officer or employee who in good faith reports a violation shall suffer harassment, retaliation or adverse employment consequences.
- A person who retaliates against someone who has reported a violation in good faith is subject to discipline up to and including termination of employment.
- Any allegations that prove not to be substantiated and which prove to have been made maliciously or knowingly to be false will be viewed as a serious disciplinary offence.
- The identity of the whistleblower, if known, shall remain confidential to those persons directly involved in applying this policy, unless the issue requires investigation by law enforcement.

Reporting

Whistleblowers can report in the first instance to the Firm's Compliance Officer who will coordinate all investigations with the necessary functions (internal and external). If the report involves the Compliance Officer, the individual can submit the notification to the Firm's CEO. If the CEO is also an interested party, one of the Board of Directors must be approached.

Individuals are encouraged to report such instances to the Firm in the first instance. However, please note that regulatory concerns can also be directly reported to VARA or other relevant authority where the circumstances warrant the same or where the whistleblower does not wish to approach the Firm. Reports can be submitted simultaneously to the Firm and authority as well.

Where reports are made to the Firm, the recipient will endeavour to notify the sender and acknowledge receipt within five business days. So far as is reasonably possible, the Firm will also endeavour to provide feedback to the whistleblower on

¹ Means any other entity in the Group to which the Firm belongs.

the report submitted. All reports will be promptly investigated, and appropriate corrective action will be taken as warranted by the investigation. Where required, the recipient may escalate the reports to the Firm's senior management, VARA and/or any other relevant authority.

Record-Keeping

The Firm will maintain a written record of each concern reported to it by a whistleblower. These records will include:

- a) the date the report was received;
- b) a summary of the concerns raised;
- c) steps taken by the Firm in relation to the report until the matter is resolved;
- d) any steps taken to maintain the confidentiality of the whistleblower and to ensure fair treatment of the whistleblower;
- e) the list of persons who have knowledge of the report;
- f) the outcome of the assessment of the report including the rationale for the outcome and any decision on whether or not to disclose the report to VARA or any other relevant authority; and
- g) references or links to all documentation and review papers in relation to the report.

These records may have to be made available to VARA for inspection where required.
